CLEAN ENERGY CONFERENCE
AFRICA AUSTRALIA
Powering the future

The transition to a sustainable future

CONFERENCE & EXHIBITION PROGRAMME

CLEAN ENERGY CONFERENCE AUSTRALIA AFRICA
6-7TH AUGUST 2026
KIGALI MARRIOT HOTEL, RWANDA

CONTACT US: +254 725 707 557

THE CLEAN ENERGY CONFERENCE & EXHIBITION
Kigali, Rwanda.

DAY ONE- 6 AUGUST 2026	
8:00 – 8:45 a.m.	**Registration and Welcome Refreshments.** **National Anthem & Conference opening by MC-**
8:45 – 9:00 a.m.	**Opening Remarks** Stephen Kuria, Executive Chairman, Australia Kenya Chamber of Commerce.
9:00 – 10:00 a.m.	**SESSION 1- Opening Address** ***Hon. Jimmy Gasore, Ministry of infrastructure*** **Opening Keynote Address** *Geopolitical of Energy- Developments, supply chain realignments, Power infrastructures and changing global energy landscape- the macroeconomic forces influencing African energy* H.E Minister of Energy Kenya H.H. E Minister of Energy Tanzania H.E. Minister of Energy Uganda H.E. Minister of Energy South Africa H.E. Minister of Energy Nigeria **Fireside Chat** *Global trade and geopolitics have continued to evolve affecting investor and political perception of exploration. With the U.S. Administration focused on the promise of cheaper, reliable and secure energy and a sudden shift across much of the west from a rapid energy "transition" to more rational energy policies, will calls for increased supply support or challenge exploration in Africa? The panel aims to explore the impact of these shifts on exploration and capital investment in Africa, where E&P companies have expanded interest in frontier areas and the fundamental need for energy access remain paramount.*
10.00-10.30 a.m.	**Networking Break and Exhibition Visit**
	SESSION 2- The Energy Paradox: Can East Africa Leapfrog to a Net-Zero Future? *As East Africa accelerates toward modernization, it faces a defining tension: how to reconcile the urgent demand for affordable, reliable energy with the global imperative to decarbonize. Are we witnessing a true green revolution, or are policy incentives merely outpacing the infrastructure?* *Today, we confront the tough questions that rarely make it into press releases:* ***Mobility:*** *Is EV adoption in East Africa a genuine solution for the masses, or a luxury play for the few while the grid remains fragile?* ***Energy:*** *Can we realistically pivot to "clean cooking" and smart grids without leaving the most vulnerable behind?* ***LPG:*** *The future of LPG in Africa, is the future of clean cooking or transportation time-bomb?* ***Industry:*** *Is the "second-life battery" market a revolutionary storage answer or just a new form of toxic waste accumulation?* ***Realism:*** *In a region still tethered to traditional resources, is the drive to "decarbonize" oil and gas an achievable target or a hollow policy promise?*

	The path to a low-carbon future is not just about technology—it is about trade-offs. Let's strip away the corporate rhetoric and debate the reality of the transition. ***Where do we draw the line between progress and wishful thinking?***
11:30 -12:30 p.m.	**SESSION 3- Next-Generation Geothermal: Hybrid Systems and Industrial Applications for a Low-Carbon Economy** *For decades, geothermal energy was the "forgotten" sibling of the renewables family—limited by geography and trapped in volcanic hotspots. Today, next-generation technologies like Enhanced Geothermal Systems (EGS) and superhot rock drilling promise to unlock infinite, 24/7 baseload power from anywhere beneath our feet. But as we pivot from experimental research to industrial-scale deployment, we must confront the uncomfortable realities of this "new" frontier:* ***The "Oil & Gas" Paradox:*** *We are borrowing drilling techniques from the fossil fuel industry to fuel our green transition. Is this a pragmatic masterstroke of engineering, or are we simply rebranding the same extractive logic that created the climate crisis?* ***The Economic Chasm:*** *Beyond the laboratory, can next-generation geothermal actually compete with the plummeting costs of solar and wind, or is this destined to remain a subsidized niche for the elite?* ***Industrial Integration:*** *While the potential for heating, cooling, and industrial polygeneration is massive, who carries the financial risk when an exploratory multi-million dollar well comes up dry?* ***Is the massive investment in "next-gen" geothermal a strategic necessity for grid reliability ?***
12.30-13.20 p.m.	**Lunch and Sponsor Showcase**
13:30 -14:30 p.m.	**SESSION 4- The Energy Crossroads: Innovation, Extraction, or Illusion**? *We are at a critical juncture in the global energy transition. We're banking on the earth's heat, betting on carbon capture, and scrambling to find the trillions needed to fund it all. But as the clock ticks toward 2030, we have to move past the glossy brochures and get honest about the risks we're taking. This panel isn't just about sharing updates; it's about testing our resolve. We'll be dismantling the following tensions:* ***The Geothermal Gamble:*** *We're eyeing next-generation geothermal to provide constant, clean power. But are we ready to scale industrial-grade drilling and hybrid systems without repeating the environmental mistakes of the past?* ***The CCUS Conundrum:*** *Carbon Capture, Utilization, and Storage is being hailed as the lifeline for oil, gas, and mining. Is this the pragmatic bridge to a net-zero future, or is it a convenient excuse to keep the carbon-heavy status quo on life support?* ***The Financing Chasm:*** *The capital exists, but the "risk" doesn't disappear just because it's labeled green. With renewable projects struggling to secure bankable models, are we creating genuine risk-sharing partnerships, or just shifting the burden onto the next generation?*
14:30 - 15:30 p.m.	**SESSION 5- Breakout Rooms Discussion**

	Breakout Room 1 **Artisanal & Critical Minerals Mining in Rwanda's Energy Transition** **Theme: Responsible Mining, Critical Minerals & Local Value Addition** *Context: Rwanda is emerging as a continental leader in responsible artisanal and small-scale mining (ASM) and critical mineral development for batteries, solar and electric mobility. This session explores how sustainable mining practices can fuel Africa's clean energy ambitions.* • *Rwanda's role iN artisanal and small-scale mining in the clean energy era.* • *Building a sustainable value chain for critical minerals.* • *Promoting responsible extraction, processing and local beneficiation.* • *Creating lasting community value and advancing national development goals.* • *Research areas: mineralization, resource mapping, and innovation.* • *Strengthening governance for transparency, inclusivity, and sustainability.* • *Understanding the geopolitics shaping Africa's critical mineral economies.* *Sustainable Mining Practices: ESG-driven operations, low-carbon mining and electrification of mines.* *Innovation in Mining Tech*
	Breakout Room 2 **Renewable Energy & Circular Economy** **Theme: Circularity as Capital – Embedding ESG into Investment Portfolios** *For too long, "circular economy" and "ESG" have been treated as corporate PR—nice-to-have metrics relegated to the back of an annual report. But as resource scarcity bites and regulatory pressure mounts, the question is no longer whether we should be circular, but whether we can afford not to be.* *We're here to cut through the boardroom buzzwords and address the uncomfortable tension between short-term yields and long-term viability:* ***Circularity as Capital:*** *Is embedding circular principles into an investment portfolio a genuine engine for new value, or is it just a complex, costly accounting exercise that dilutes investor returns?* ***The Valuation Gap:*** *If the market continues to prioritize linear "take-make-waste" growth, can circular business models ever truly compete for the big capital? Or are we stuck in a system that penalizes the very innovation we need to survive?* ***The Accountability Trap:*** *How do we move from "ESG reporting" to "ESG impact"? When the data is murky and greenwashing is rampant, who holds the responsibility—and the liability—for proving that a portfolio is actually circular?* *This isn't about being "green"; it's about the future of capital allocation.* ***Are we genuinely redesigning the mechanics of investment to support a circular economy, or are we just slapping an ESG sticker on a broken, linear model?***
15:30 – 16:30 p.m.	**SESSION 6- The Deal Room: Where Vision Hits the Bottom Line** *The gap between a brilliant green idea and a bankable project is often a graveyard of failed ventures. Today, we aren't just listening to pitches; we're stress-testing the future of our most critical sectors.*

	*We have four high-stakes arenas—**Renewable Energy, Circularity/Waste-to-Energy, Artisanal Mining, and Geothermal/Smart Grids.** But the promise of these technologies is meaningless if the math doesn't hold up in the real world. As we open the floor to our entrepreneurs and investors, we are here to probe the uncomfortable questions that decide whether a business survives or vanishes:* ***The Scalability Reality Check:** Does this solution actually solve a systemic problem, or is it just a high-tech "niche" play that will struggle to survive outside of a pilot project?* ***The Risk/Reward Paradox:** Investors want impact, but they demand returns. Which of these pitches is actually offering a breakthrough, and which is just hiding behind buzzwords while ignoring the harsh economic realities of their sector?* ***The "True" Impact:** Beyond the glossy presentation decks, how much of this is genuinely driving a low-carbon transition, and how much of it is just efficient business as usual?* *This is where the rubber meets the road. **To the entrepreneurs: can you prove your model is built to last? And to the investors: are you genuinely hunting for innovation, or are you just playing it safe in a rapidly changing world?*** ***Which of these sectors do you think is currently the most over-hyped, and which one is the most dangerously undervalued by the investment community today?***
16.30 p.m.	**Evening Tea and Networking**
7.00 p.m.	**African Energy Awards & Gala Dinner – Invitation Only** *The African Energy Awards & Gala Dinner is a prestigious event celebrating outstanding achievements in Africa's energy sector. Designed to honour innovators, leaders and trailblazers across the continent, the awards recognise excellence across multiple categories that reflect the diversity and impact of the industry. This exclusive event highlights and celebrates the exceptional contributions driving Africa's clean energy transformation and shaping the future of sustainable energy across the region.*

DAY 2- 7 AUGUST 2026	
8:00 – 8:45 a.m.	**Registration and Welcome Refreshments.** **National Anthem & Conference opening by MC-**
8:45 – 9:00 a.m.	**Welcome & Recap of Day 1**
9:00 – 10:00 a.m.	**SESSION 7- The Capital Paradox: Why Isn't Africa's Energy Transition Moving Faster?** *We keep hearing that Africa is the next great frontier for green energy—a continent poised to leapfrog legacy infrastructure and define the net-zero era. Yet, despite the massive influx of "climate finance" rhetoric, the gap between ambition and actual deployment remains a chasm.* *Today, we move past the polished presentations to confront the uncomfortable bottlenecks in our investment systems:* ***The De-Risking Illusion:*** *We talk endlessly about "blended finance" and sovereign support. But are these models actually de-risking projects, or are they just creating complex layers of bureaucracy that keep capital trapped in boardrooms while the lights stay off on the ground?* ***The ESG Reality Check:*** *Is "ESG" in an African context a genuine tool for sustainable development, or has it become a comfortable compliance shield that allows investors to check boxes while ignoring the systemic hurdles that prevent large-scale impact?* ***The True Cost of Capital:*** *When we look at* ***private equity*** *and* ***sovereign fund strategies,*** *we have to ask: are these investors truly aligned with Africa's long-term climate resilience, or are they still hunting for short-term, low-risk returns in a landscape that requires a different kind of courage*
10.00-10.30 a.m.	**Networking Break and Exhibition Visit**
10:30 – 11:30 a.m.	**SESSION 8- The Critical Nexus: Can Africa Balance Growth, Water, and Global Standards?** *In regions already under the shadow of climate stress, we face an uncomfortable, three-way tug-of-war: mining needs water, energy production requires both, and the local communities who rely on these resources are increasingly at the center of the crossfire. Meanwhile, global investors are demanding strict ESG alignment—often using frameworks that feel worlds away from the reality of development on the ground in Africa.* *Today, we are moving past the "checklist" approach to sustainability to address the raw, systemic friction of these competing demands:* ***The Nexus Crisis:*** *As water becomes our most precious and volatile asset, how can we possibly sustain a mining and energy sector that is fundamentally resource-intensive? Are we prioritizing economic extraction at the expense of our own climate resilience?* ***The ESG Disconnect:*** *Global investors want standardized metrics, but are these standards actually serving African growth, or are they creating a "compliance burden" that pushes out local innovators and hinders the very development we need?* ***The Path Forward:*** *Can we build a uniquely African model for sustainability—one that satisfies global capital without sacrificing the livelihoods and natural resources of the communities at the heart of these projects?*

	This isn't a conversation about "how to comply." This is a debate about "how to survive and thrive." ***Are our current sustainability standards helping us build a future-proof economy, or are we just papering over the cracks of an unsustainable model?*** ***Which is the greater threat to our progress: the physical limits of our water and energy resources, or the misalignment between local realities and the rigid expectations of global financial markets?*** ***Can Africa Lead The Green Economy?***
11:30 – 12:00 p.m	**SESSION 9- The Human & Resource Crisis: Are We Building the Future on Shaky Ground?** *As we race to pivot Africa's economy toward a low-carbon future, we are facing two critical, often ignored, bottlenecks: the physical survival of our resources and the human capacity to manage them. We are simultaneously navigating the intense* ***Water-Energy-Mining nexus*** *and a* ***workforce revolution*** *that is moving faster than our training systems can keep up.* *Today, we are moving past the glossy corporate brochures to face some hard, uncomfortable truths:* ***The Resource Tug-of-War:*** *In a climate-stressed world, water is the ultimate currency. When mining, energy, and community needs collide, who loses? Are our current sustainability standards and ESG metrics actually protecting these resources, or are they just providing a "green" smokescreen for continued extraction?* ***The Talent Chasm:*** *We talk about "transitioning industries," but who is doing the work? As sectors evolve rapidly, our workforce planning is falling behind. Are we genuinely upskilling the next generation of African talent, or are we relying on imported expertise while our own workforce gets left in the wake of automation and rapid sector shifts?* ***The Alignment Trap:*** *Are we chasing global ESG standards that were designed for a different world, or are we building a local framework that actually addresses the specific realities of African development?* *This is not a session for quiet consensus. We are here to debate the friction between our economic ambitions and the physical and human realities of this transition.*
12:00 – 12:30 p.m	**SESSION 10- From Garbage to Gold: Is Waste-to-Energy a Breakthrough or a Band-Aid?** *Every city and industrial hub in Africa is sitting on a mountain of potential fuel: urban trash, agricultural residues, and mining tailings. The promise of "Waste-to-Energy" (WtE) is intoxicating—solve the waste crisis while generating the power we desperately need. But before we get ahead of ourselves, we need to ask: is this circularity, or is it just efficient incineration?* *This panel is here to challenge the hype and look at the messy reality of the circular economy:* ***The Circularity Paradox:*** *Is converting waste to energy truly a "circular" solution, or are we just creating a new dependency that incentivizes us to keep producing waste to keep the power plants running?* ***The Economic Reality:*** *We hear the success stories, but what about the graveyard of failed WtE projects? Is it possible to make these models bankable and scalable without massive public subsidies, or are we chasing a pipedream?*

	The Mining & Ag Burden: *Turning mining waste and agricultural residue into energy is technically brilliant—but who carries the environmental and health costs? Are we cleaning up our industries, or just finding a "greener" way to manage our pollution?* *We aren't here for a lecture on sustainability; we are here for a debate on economics and ethics.* ***If we truly succeed in creating a circular economy, do we eventually "waste" ourselves out of a power source? And more importantly: are these projects genuinely empowering our communities, or are they just the latest corporate experiment?***
12.30- 13.20 p.m.	**Lunch and Roundtable Discussions**
13:30 – 14:30 p.m	**SESSION 11- The Smart City Mirage: Progress or Privilege?** *We are constantly sold the vision of the "African Smart City"—a high-tech, electrified, and sustainable urban future. But beneath the glossy renderings of green buildings and automated grids lies a stubborn reality: Africa's cities are growing faster than their infrastructure, and the gap between our high-tech ambitions and the lived experience of our citizens is widening.* *Today, we move beyond the buzzwords of "efficiency" and "innovation" to face the difficult questions about who these smart cities are actually for:* ***The Accessibility Gap:*** *We are pushing for "green" buildings and smart electrification, but are we creating a two-tier society? Are these technologies serving the general population, or are they exclusively for the affluent while the vast majority remain sidelined in informal, under-served settlements?* ***The Grid Dilemma:*** *Our conventional grids are aging and unreliable, yet we talk about "smart grid integration." Are we skipping the essential work of basic maintenance and infrastructure for the sake of shiny new tech, or can we actually leapfrog into a distributed, resilient future?* ***The "Luxury" Label:*** *Is sustainable construction truly a necessity for Africa's climate future, or is it an expensive "luxury" import that ignores the necessity of affordable, low-cost housing? How do we scale green standards without pricing out the people who need shelter most?* ***Data and Governance:*** *Smart cities rely on data, but our urban systems are often fragmented and informal. Who owns the data, and can we realistically govern these complex systems without falling into the traps of surveillance and exclusionary planning?* *This isn't a conversation about the "future of tech"; it's about the future of urban equity.* ***Are we genuinely building cities that work for everyone, or are we just using "smart" technology to build smarter versions of the same old unequal cities?*** ***In your opinion, what is the biggest barrier to creating inclusive smart cities in Africa: is it the lack of reliable energy infrastructure, the high cost of green building technology, or a failure of urban policy to account for informal settlements?***
14:30 – 15:30 p.m.	**SESSION 12- The Agri-Energy Paradox: Feeding the Future or Fueling the Grid?** *We talk about the "Water-Energy-Food Nexus" as the holy grail of sustainable development. Technologies like* ***agrivoltaics****—harvesting solar energy above the very land where we grow our crops—promise to turn a zero-sum conflict into a dual-harvest win. But beneath the optimistic diagrams of shaded crops*

	and solar-powered irrigation, there is a complex reality we aren't fully addressing. *Today, we move past the pilot projects to debate the systemic trade-offs of integrating energy into our food systems:* ***The Land-Use Tension:*** *Is dual-use solar a genuine solution for smallholders, or are we inadvertently creating a new form of land-grabbing where energy production overshadows the primary goal of feeding communities?* ***The "Technological Fix" Trap:*** *Solar irrigation is a massive leap over diesel, but are we just swapping one dependency for another? If the technology fails, who bears the burden—the tech provider or the farmer whose season is now at risk?* ***The Scaling Hurdle:*** *Why, despite the clear benefits, are these models still struggling to move from small-scale demonstrations to the mainstream? Is it a failure of financing, a lack of infrastructure, or are we ignoring the cultural and structural realities of rural farming?* ***The Governance of Resources:*** *When we link energy and water, we increase the complexity of the system. Can our current policy and regulatory frameworks handle the management of these hybrid systems, or are we setting ourselves up for a regulatory mess?* *This isn't a session for polite agreement. We are here to pressure-test the most promising nexus of our time.* ***Is agrivoltaics the breakthrough that will secure Africa's food systems, or are we just hoping that layering technology over agriculture will solve the deep-rooted issues of production, poverty, and climate vulnerability?*** ***In your view, what is the biggest threat to the successful adoption of agri-energy: the high capital cost of the technology, or the danger of prioritizing "energy output" over the fundamental resilience of our food supply?***
15:30 – 16:30 p.m.	**SESSION 13- The Innovation Gap: Breakthrough or Just Hype?** *We are surrounded by a constant stream of "game-changing" research—from advanced mining technologies and digital twins to the next generation of energy storage. Yet, when we step out of the lab and into the field, the translation of these innovations into industrial reality remains frustratingly slow.* *Today, we aren't just here to review academic breakthroughs; we are here to hold them accountable. We are stripping away the jargon to confront the bridge between high-tech research and actual, on-the-ground impact:* ***The Digital Twin Mirage:*** *Digital twins are marketed as the ultimate efficiency tool for mining and energy. But are they actually solving operational bottlenecks, or are we just creating expensive virtual replicas of broken, inefficient systems?* ***The Lab-to-Mine Divide:*** *We see brilliant innovations in mining and energy tech, but why do so many promising prototypes die in the pilot phase? Is the industry structurally allergic to risk, or are these technologies simply not built for the harsh realities of African field conditions?* ***The Scalability Test:*** *How much of this research is actually scalable for the average operator, and how much is just "prestige tech" designed for industry giants with deep pockets and little appetite for the systemic change we actually need?* ***Data Sovereignty:*** *As we integrate digital twins and smart tech into our infrastructure, who really owns the insights? Are we building systems that*

	empower local operators, or are we locking ourselves into a new dependency on proprietary, external technologies? *This is a space for critical inquiry.* ***To the researchers: are you building solutions for a laboratory environment, or for the messy, complex reality of the industry? And to the industry leaders: are you genuinely looking for breakthroughs, or are you just looking for the next gadget to polish your "innovation" credentials?*** ***In your opinion, which is the bigger barrier to innovation today: the lack of funding to bridge the "valley of death" between research and deployment, or a fundamental cultural resistance within the industry to adopt radical new ways of working?***
16:30 – 17.00 p.m.	**SESSION 14- The Road Ahead: From Consensus to Concrete Action** *We came here to debate, but we stay to deliver. Over the past few sessions, we have dismantled the myths of the "easy transition" and confronted the raw friction between our climate ambitions and the economic realities of the African market. We've questioned the "green" credentials of our current industry models, poked holes in our financing structures, and demanded more than just empty ESG promises.* *But if we walk out of these doors and back into our silos, this was just another conference. The transition requires more than ideas; it requires a movement.* ***Our Shared Roadmap*** ***The Policy Pivot:*** *We aren't just talking about carbon targets; we are launching the new* ***"Pan-African Green Energy Roadmap"****. This initiative isn't a policy paper—it's a living framework designed to de-risk investment and demand transparency from the top down.* ***The Action Pact:*** *We are moving from debate to delivery.* ***The Network:*** *This conversation does not end here. We are officially opening the* ***, "Climate Transition Network"]****—a permanent, digital, and physical hub for investors, entrepreneurs, and policymakers to hold one another accountable.* ***The Final Challenge*** *We've identified the bottlenecks—be it the water-energy-mining nexus, the talent gap, or the chasm in our financing models. Now, we have to bridge them.* ***Are you going to be the ones who maintain the status quo, or the ones who break it?*** *We've done the questioning; now, let's do the work.* ***Join us in the next chapter. Stay connected, stay critical, and let's get to building.*** ***Are you ready to commit? We'll be tracking our progress through Linkend, Website and handle. What is one specific, measurable goal you are taking away from this conference to move your sector forward in the next 12 months?***